

25 Great Gifts for \$5 or Less

Having struggled with gift-list limiting (I have 1 husband, 2 children, 2 parents, 9 nieces and nephews, and 12 in-laws) and being hopeless at crafts, I have opted for creative gift buying with some occasional holiday baking. Here are 25 non-crafty gift ideas, all for less than \$5, and suitable for nearly everyone on your list.



1. Fruit basket

These are pricey if you order them fully prepared and decorated from a gift basket company, but it's easy to make your own. You'll need a source of good-quality (preferably in-season) fruits for a good price—\$4–\$5 should

get you a nice offering. Put them in a dollar-store basket and you've got a fruit-basket gift for just under \$5.

2. Flashlight

Everyone can use a flashlight, right? This gift will be especially useful for the outdoorsy type, but is great for anyone who needs to see outside at night or who happens to find him/herself off the grid or without power. Find one at your favorite hardware store or look for bargains online at Amazon.com or Rakuten.com.

3. Classic books

Dover Thrift Editions have been one of my holiday traditions for nieces and nephews. Titles include *A Christmas Carol* and *Anna Karenina*, which you can find at the Dover online store.

4. Children's books

You'll also find great buys on classic children's books at Dover. Check out the Dover Evergreen Classics or Children's Thrift Classics.

5. Oven mitt

Ever notice at potluck dinners how oven mitts are nearly always stained and ragged (even those owned by the most persnickety perfectionists)? A